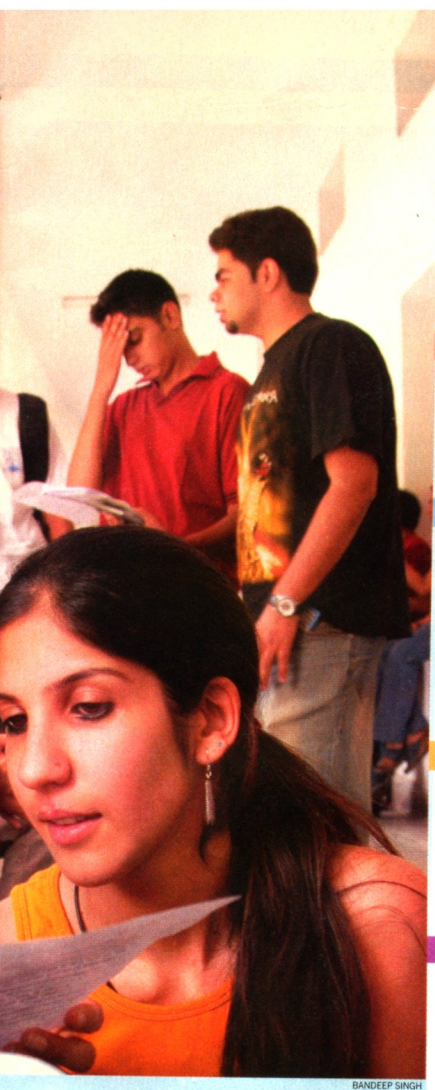




BANDEEP SINGH

Step 1

A list of over 1,400 colleges in arts, commerce, science, engineering, medicine and law streams was prepared.

Step 2

More than 600 colleges were shortlisted on the basis of the perception of 360 experts across 12 cities.

Step 3

Another 540 experts were approached to get perceptual scores on seven parameters for the shortlisted colleges. On the basis of these scores, 270 colleges across all six streams were selected.

Step 4

Factual information was collected from the selected colleges on parameters such as infrastructure, placements and faculty.

Step 5

To get the overall score for the colleges, a weightage of 70:30 was applied to the perceptual and factual scores.

achievements to peer review are better placed to improve their rankings over the years. Those that make changes but do not make a noise about these in public would find recognition coming in slower. As Hollywood director Mel Brooks humourously put it, "If you're alive, you got to flap your arms and legs, you got to jump around a lot, you got to make a lot of noise, because life is the very opposite of death. And, therefore, if you're quiet, you're not living."

What the survey does is provide the 6,00,000 aspirants planning to enter college this summer a powerful torchlight with which to negotiate the maze and come up with some clear choices. Over the years, if INDIA TODAY's survey has become an unofficial barometer of academic excellence, it

is because the government's efforts in this direction have never really made much headway.

For colleges that do not make it to the Top 10 rankings, it would be wise to remember the adage that the road to success is always under construction. By expanding the rankings to bring out 50 of the best colleges in the arts, science and commerce streams, the survey affords colleges that do not figure in the honours list an idea of just how far or near they are to the top.

As the survey has demonstrated over the years, the pinnacle is always a slippery slope and colleges that make the right changes and effort can zoom to the top. Remember what the Buddha said: "To know and not to do, is not to know." So, do.

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